The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Tirdas, the 20th of Frostfall (Tuesday, October 20, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 20 · Price: One Septim



Gandy naps through the clouds while Maevy bats at a falling leaf.

Skies o'er the Hold

71° / 57°

Partly Cloudy

Sunrise 6:35 AM · Sunset 5:44 PM

Tomorrow — Scattered thunderstorms, 69/57

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday First Quarter · *Tonight* Waxing Gibbous · *Tomorrow* waxing toward the full moon

20th of Frostfall = October 20

Months run one-for-one all year
Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Volleyballs, Paint Brushes, and a Trail to Build



Payson, Ariz.



Volleyball in Payson, painters in Sedona, and trail builders in Pine — one busy morning across the Holds.

Hail, wayfarer, and good Tirdas morning from under the Rim — the pines are cool, the sky is partly cloudy over Payson, and the Holds are busy in the best way. In Payson the Longhorn girls take on Blue Ridge at volleyball tonight, in Pine-Strawberry neighbors gather this morning to build trail, and in Sedona painters are out catching red-rock light for the Plein Air Festival. Later this week comes the Monster Mash at Green Valley Park, awards night in Sedona, and an open mic in Pine, so fill your mug, mind the late storms tomorrow, and plan a fine week.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**
  — **Varsity Volleyball — Blue Ridge vs. Payson**, 6:30 p.m. at Payson High School, 301 S. McLane Rd. The Longhorn girls host Blue Ridge in an evening match that should draw a good home crowd. Come cheer loud, support the home side, and enjoy a classic small-town night in the gym. It is a fine, easy outing for guests who want a taste of real Payson life.

- **Pine-Strawberry**
  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build in Pine**, 7:00 a.m. to noon off Highway 87 just before Pine. Volunteers help clear brush, move rocks, and shape a trail that will serve hikers, bikers, and runners for years, and that also helps fire crews reach the forest when needed. Tools are provided, no experience is needed, and you should bring water, sunscreen, gloves if you have them, and sturdy shoes.

- **Sedona**

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — Artist Demonstration**, 1:00 to 3:00 p.m. at the Sedona Arts Center. The festival runs October 16–24, with master painters working outdoors all week to catch the red rocks in real light. Today's free demonstration is a chance to watch a painting come together, ask how the artist chooses a scene, and then wander the gallery to see work made this week.

The Days Ahead

- **Wed, Oct. 21**

  — **Show Low — Trick or Treat Trail**. The City of Show Low's live feed lists the Trick or Treat Trail for Wednesday, October 21. It is a family Halloween outing on the trail, made for costumes, candy, and an easy evening walk. Check the city's page before you go for the latest start details, and bring a bag for treats and a light for the walk back.

- **Thu, Oct. 22**

  — **Monthly Meeting in Payson**, 6:00 to 7:00 p.m. at the American Legion, 709 E. Hwy. 260, Payson. Listed as a monthly meeting to discuss runs and events, this is a neighborly evening stop for folks who follow local rides and gatherings. Arrive a little early if you want to meet people before the meeting starts.

- **Fri, Oct. 23**

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — Awards Night**, 5:00 to 7:00 p.m. at the Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Road. After a week of painting the red rocks outdoors, the festival artists gather for awards and a reception. It is the best night to see the week's strongest work in one room, meet painters, and hear which canvases the judges chose. The festival closes the next day.

  — **Truckload Meat Sale in Payson**, 10:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. in the Tractor Supply parking lot, 510 SR-260, Payson. The listing advertises 20 ribeyes for $50, family packs of beef, chicken, seafood, and pork, and discounts for first responders, military, and seniors on some items. It runs again Saturday, October 24, 9:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m., while stock lasts.

- **Sat, Oct. 24**

  — **Monster Mash in Payson**, 4:00 to 9:30 p.m. at Green Valley Park. Payson's big Halloween evening returns earlier this year so families have more time to come and go. Bring chairs and blankets for the Halloween movie, The Nightmare Before Christmas, and enjoy costumes, crowds, and a fall night in the park with Valley Dwellers up for the cool Rim air.

  — **Fall Arts & Crafts Show in Sedona**, 9:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. at the Sedona Heritage Museum. The annual show brings makers and crafts back to the museum grounds for a day of browsing. Pair it with the Plein Air Festival's closing community paint-out and final art sale, 10:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. at the Sedona Arts Center, for a full art day among the red rocks.

  — **Costumes for Kids 5K & Halloween Fest in Prescott**, from 9:00 a.m. at Prescott Courthouse Square downtown. A costume-friendly run and Halloween festival in the heart of Prescott, made for families who like their fall fun active. Come in costume, cheer the runners, and spend the rest of the morning around the square's shops and cafes.

- **Mon, Oct. 26**

  — **Open Mic Night at THAT Brewery & Pub in Pine**, 4:00 to 7:00 p.m., 3270 AZ-87, Pine. Singers, poets, storytellers, and first-timers are all welcome, hosted by rotating members of the Fuel Reduction Team, with tips benefiting Fuel Reduction. Share a song, bring a guitar, or just cheer on your neighbors with a pint in the pines.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The shield, the torches, and the doors — the Hearth's workshop quests await.

- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Overdue — was due Oct. 17. Finalize the size, cut and engrave the layered plywood, mount the 3D-printed troll relief, and finish with spar urethane.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Due Oct. 24. Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, placed for best sight from the walkway.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue — was due Oct. 10. Paint, seal for sun, wire the sockets with the breaker off, mount both torches, and test at dusk.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Oct. 3. Print two torches plus the socket test piece and test-fit the bulb and socket.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Sept. 26. Measure the bulb and socket, scale the sconce model, check the door-light wiring, and slice in PETG.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Due Oct. 24. The front and side door work for the guest house.

Due Saturday, Oct. 24: mount the shield by the front door, and the doors quest comes due the same day — the workshop will be busy, by the Nine!

Merchant of the Hold

The Hike House · *Sedona*



The Hike House in Sedona — boots, maps, and wise trail counsel before the red rocks.

Sedona's premier hiking shop is part gear store, part trail guide, and part refueling stop — a little enchantment in the Trail Finder lets you match over 100 Sedona trails to your legs and your time, as if by a friendly spell. Shop sturdy footwear, hiking and athletic apparel, maps and Sedona's well-loved hiking book, then grab a smoothie, cookie, or coffee at the Energy Cafe before you head out. The signature thing to try is the Trail Finder help itself: tell them what you hope to see, and let the staff point you to the right red-rock trail.

> *"We had a great experience here, Ian helped us out and he is very knowledgeable. He even took the time to answer questions about hike trails and showed us in a map. The store was stocked with a variety of things, worth stopping by."* — Google review via Wanderlog

431 AZ-179 Ste B1, Sedona, AZ 86336. Hours: Mon.–Sat. 9 a.m.–6 p.m., Sun. 9 a.m.–5 p.m. Phone: (928) 282-5820. Price range: moderate. Good to know: go before your hike, not after — the trail advice is the real treasure, and weekends can be busy. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you:
Because a good trail, well chosen, is half the Sedona visit — and these folks send you out fitted, fed, and pointed the right way, every time. Great praise is great, and this shop has earned it!

Tales from the Treeline

The Great Acorn Tower



Jethro's acorn tower — finest in the Hold, for nine whole seconds.

That dang ol' Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) woke up under a partly cloudy sky with a grand plan: he would stack acorns into a tower tall enough, he said, to wave at the Rim.

Earl (an elk) agreed to judge, which mostly meant standing very still and looking dignified while acorns rolled off his hooves. Henny (the Hearth's chicken) supervised from a stump, unbothered, as always. Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) tried to help by chilling the bottom acorns together, which worked beautifully until the sun warmed them and the whole tower sighed down in one soft clatter.

Jethro did not mind. He built it again, shorter and wider, and crowned it with one perfect acorn. Earl nodded once, very seriously, and the acorn fell off. Everyone agreed it was the finest tower the clearing had ever seen, for the full nine seconds it stood.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Tirdas be free of skeevers, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com